8.1 Marketing Concept

The marketing concept is used by a company to analyze and implement ideas to satisfy customers' needs, increase sales, maximize returns and sustain among the competitors. There are many marketing concepts, which are interrelated and rely on each other.

DO YOU KNOW?

Penetration Pricing

Lowering price of product to stimulate demand and increase the customer turnover.

The five major marketing concepts are:

1) **Production concept** - Consumers will favour products that are available and highly affordable. For E.g.: availability of simple snacks like popcorn, fried groundnuts and soups near schools, colleges, supermarkets and theatres are good marketable production concepts ideal for children and adolescents.

2) **Selling concept** - Consumers buy products when there is large scale selling and promotion. For E.g.: if a new food is marketed, an offer in price or a gift given along with the product free of cost is a selling concept.

3) **Product concept** - Consumers will welcome a product that has durability and multiple usages. For E.g.. Modular or custom made equipments which perform a variety of tasks are ideal for a food service organization.

4) **Marketing concept** - In this concept customer first approach is followed. A customer first approach means that a product to be marketed is produced or manufactured keeping the needs and wants of a target customer in mind. For E.g.:many food products are specifically prepared for a target age group that is, foods like pastries are very popular among the younger age group and such products are marketed in kiosks, cafeteria and small shops.

5) **Social marketing concept** - Marketing strategy should deliver value to the customers. The social marketing concept gives importance to human welfare more priority than profits and keeps customer satisfaction as the prime objective. One example can be environmental responsible marketing like avoiding plastics in food packaging and service.

8.2 Marketing Mix

A number of variables will be used by a food service to achieve its sales target and the mixture of variables is



Plate 8.2 Marketing Mix

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